

Multicore

AMD to release six-core processors in the second quarter of 2010

USB 3.0

WD announces USB 3.0 range of MyBook external storage drives

Your problem is no problem to us!

This month, we look at Khatarnakh viruses, master/slave issues with hard drives, and much more

Khatarnakh virus!

Two months back, three viruses – Khatarnakh, Ghost and Xplorer attacked my PC. The Khatarnakh virus spawned a process called khatra.exe and the other two viruses spawned ghost.exe and xplorer.exe. These viruses have disabled my Control Panel and are not letting me change any settings. I tried opening it from C:\Windows\System32\control.exe, but it just displays a warning window with the message This operation has been cancelled due to restrictions on your computer. Please contact your system administrator.

In fact, there is no Control Panel icon on my desktop. I deleted the viruses from all the locations and even removed the registry entries. After deleting the viruses, other shortcuts such as [Alt]+[F4] have got enabled. I cannot even set my Desktop background and also the title bar of Internet Explorer displays "Internet Exploiter" instead of "Internet Explorer".

The registry editor is also disabled. I access it from "TuneUp Utilities 2008" software. My system has an Intel Celeron M Processor 530, 512MB DDR2 RAM, and Windows Vista Ultimate Edition.

Vinay

 The virus problem is a little too complicated to get rid of manually. It would be easier to install an anti-virus solution from Kaspersky, ESET or G DATA. You should use an anti-virus to remove the infection. If all fails, you might have to do a clean install of Windows.

Random crashes

I recently upgraded my Acer system seven to eight months ago. It has an Intel Core 2 Duo processor, 2 GB DDR 2 RAM, and 320 GB hard drive. It was working fine for the last seven months, but all of a sudden it starts giving "Generic Host Controller" errors while surfing. Using the DOS window, Windows closes in just five to six seconds. I'm unable to run C++ compilers and environments.

To overcome this problem, I formatted my C drive and installed a licenced version of Windows XP and also activated it. On the second day, the same problem occurred. So, I tried enabling system restore, but it is shown as disabled by group policy. I have tried to enable system restore using the gpedit.msc command, but it doesn't work. I have formatted the system again. At present, the system is running normally and system restore can be done also. I have checked for virus also. System doesn't have any viruses. I have created

two system restore points, but it is of no use in case "system restore disabled by group policy".

Harshit H. Desai

 Firstly, Group Policy Editor is only available in Windows XP Professional. If you're using a different version, you won't be able to access it. Also, update to the latest Windows XP

Watch the Q&A segment on Digit TV



Service Pack 3. Try updating all your drivers for the system, and also run a thorough memory scan of the system.

The random closing of the DOS window is really odd. It could be memory problems or

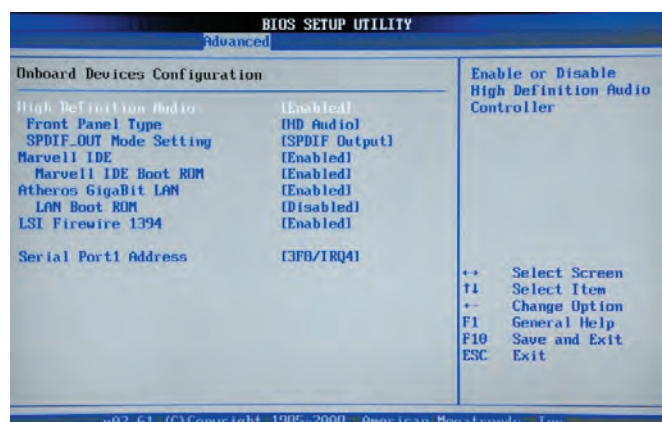
just Windows. You should try a Windows repair instead of a reinstall. Viruses could be a problem. Try a different anti-virus or any of the free online virus scanners to be sure.

RAM not recognised

I just assembled my new PC with Biostar TA790GXBE motherboard and Athlon X2 245 with Windows XP SP2. The problem is that my computer recognises only 768 MB RAM instead of the 1 GB installed. My older Pentium 4 system recognised the same RAM stick as 0.99 GB.

The PC was assembled into a Zebronics cabinet. Everything works fine, except the front audio-in / out ports. Even the Realtek audio manager does not recognise these ports. My shop keeper told me this is a usual problem with present day cabinets.

Rajdeep Banik



Setting the audio controller to AC97 can allow you to use audio on front ports